# Combat · Saturday · 5 PCs at level 4

Rolls and initiative at the table. Damage is fixed: no damage dice. Write HP in the boxes.

## The trap in the binding

**MATCHUPS** Shears 1 and 2 each take a lane to the article, one from each side. The cart and the swarm go for whoever blocks a lane. Ask the table who's guarding the book.

> R1 · Both shears dive for the page. The cart rolls at the first blocker.
> R2 · The swarm engulfs a blocker. One pair of shears goes down.
> R3 · The second pair drops, and everything else drops with it.

**WIN** Drop both shears. When the second pair goes down, the rest of the stationery drops where it is.

**LOSING?** Nobody dies here: a PC at 0 HP is out cold and stable. If it's going badly, the shears finish the page (5 cuts) and everything drops.

**CUTS** start at 1: 1–2 → 9 pieces · 3–4 → 16 · 5+ → 25. Tally: _____

**Archival shears ×2** `AC 14 · HP 12 · fly 30`

1. **A PC between it and the article?** Snip that PC: **+5 to hit, 6 slashing**. No cut this turn.
2. **Nobody in the way?** It flies to the article and cuts. No roll. **Tap +1 cut.**

It never goes after anyone who isn't in its way.

DROPS It snaps shut and clatters to the floor.

1 ☐ 2 ☐

**Swarm of index cards** `AC 12 · HP 22 · fly 30`

1. Moves onto the PC blocking a shears lane (or the nearest PC).
2. Paper cuts: **+5 to hit, 7 slashing**.

**Fire does double.**

DROPS The cards settle like snow and lie still.

HP ☐

**The book cart** `AC 14 · HP 33 · 30`

1. Rolls at the PC blocking a shears lane (or the nearest PC).
2. Ram: **+5 to hit, 9 bludgeoning**, and that PC is pushed 10 ft, out of the lane.

DROPS A wheel comes off; it tips over and spills its books.

HP ☐

## First contact — a pressure scene, not a fight

**WIN** Nobody wins. They get grabbed, shoved and scared, and nobody gets hurt.

**ENDS** When Orlok says one word: after a round or two, or the moment it stops being fun.

**LOSING?** They can't lose. No Bite, no damage, nobody drops.

**Dracula** `AC 16 · HP — · 40, climbs walls`

1. Swoops 40 ft at whoever failed Stealth and grabs them: **DC 15 Str or Dex save** or grappled. Escaping takes their action and a **DC 15** Athletics or Acrobatics check.
2. **Already holding someone?** Shoves them 10 ft toward the others, or pins them and looms.
3. **Orlok speaks?** Lets go and steps back. Done.

**No Bite. No damage. Nobody drops.** No HP to track: if they hit him, he laughs.

DROPS He doesn't. Orlok's one word ends it.

ALSO IN THE HALL

**Orlok** · Doesn't act. When you're ready to end it: one word.

**Edward** · Doesn't act. Watches Bix.

## The botched summoning

**MATCHUPS** The summoning takes whoever stands between it and the sealed door. Fragments 1 and 2 go for the PCs hitting it; fragments 3 and 4 go for the back line.

> R1 · The fragments swarm. It lurches for the door.
> R2 · It claws whoever is in its way. The fragments start crumbling.
> R3 · Under half: the Unfinished Word.
> R4 · It drops. The monitor line.

**WIN** Drop the summoning. The fragments crumble with it.

**LOSING?** It never attacks a PC at 0 HP: it wants the door. If two PCs are down, it tears through the wall toward the sealed door and comes apart on the threshold. Read the kill line anyway.

**The botched summoning** `AC 13 · HP 85 · 30`

1. Lurches toward the sealed door down the hall. It can't leave the room.
2. Claws twice at the nearest PC: **+6 to hit, 9 slashing** each.
3. **Once, the first time it's under 43 HP:** Unfinished Word. Every PC within 15 ft makes a **DC 13 Wis save**: 13 psychic, half on a save.

Never attacks a PC at 0 HP.

DROPS Run the wreckage search first. Then read the monitor line, fire the AIM chime, and kill all sound.

HP ☐

**Ritual fragments ×4** `AC 12 · HP 7 · 30`

1. Goes for whoever is hitting the summoning (or the nearest PC).
2. Grab: **+4 to hit, 5 necrotic**.

DROPS Crumbles to chalk dust.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

# Combat · Sunday · 5 PCs at level 5

Rolls and initiative at the table. Damage is fixed: no damage dice. Write HP in the boxes.

## The circle stirs — reserve, don't plan on it

**MATCHUPS** The remnant takes the nearest PC. Fragments 1–4 split across the rest.

> R1 · The fragments swarm. The remnant claws the nearest PC.
> R2 · The fragments crumble. Under half: the Unfinished Word.
> R3 · It drops.

**WIN** Drop the remnant. The fragments crumble with it.

**LOSING?** Same as last night: it never attacks a PC at 0 HP. If two PCs are down, it smears apart on its own.

**The remnant** — **AC 14 · HP 100 · 30**

1. Moves to the nearest PC. It can't leave the room.
2. Claws twice: **+7 to hit, 11 slashing** each.
3. **Once, the first time it's under 50 HP:** Unfinished Word. Every PC within 15 ft makes a **DC 14 Wis save**: 18 psychic, half on a save.

Never attacks a PC at 0 HP.

DROPS Chalk dust. The circle is just a drawing now.

HP ☐

**Ritual fragments ×4** — **AC 12 · HP 10 · 30**

1. Goes for the nearest PC.
2. Grab: **+5 to hit, 6 necrotic**.

DROPS Crumbles to chalk dust.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

## The developer

**MATCHUPS** Thugs 1–3 block the party. Thugs 4–6 are on the vampires. Ostrander ignores the party until they interfere. Poe Boy stays up on the decks, on the mic; he isn't in this fight.

> R1 · Thugs 1–3 block and swing. A stake rests on Orlok's chest.
> R2 · Thugs 1–3 start dropping. Dracula is pinned mid-flourish near Yobo.
> R3 · Ostrander is exposed. A stake over Edward's chest, with Bix watching.
> R4 · He goes down. Stop. Silence. The seal breaks.

**ALLIES** Pinned: the vampires don't act, and are never actually killed. When the seal breaks they finish thugs 4–6. Angelique calls off one of thugs 1–3 each round. Narrate it, no rolls.

**WIN** Drop Ostrander. The party has to do it, not the vampires.

**LOSING?** If two PCs are down: the seal slips and Orlok gets a hand free. Ostrander loses his turns, and the next hit from a PC kills him.

**W. Ostrander** — **AC 15 · HP 100 · 30**

1. **No PC has hit him or reached him?** Ignores the party and works on the vampires.
2. **A PC hit him since his last turn?** Hold that PC: **DC 15 Wis save** or they lose their next turn, frozen.
3. Surveyor's rod at a PC next to him: **+6 to hit, 10 bludgeoning**.

The first 25 damage is his ward cracking: narrate it, it's in the 100. No damage spells. Doesn't swing at a PC who's down.

DROPS He's dead. Stop. Silence. The seal breaks: the vampires finish thugs 4–6, no rolls. Any of thugs 1–3 left drop their crowbars.

HP ☐

**Thugs ×6** — **AC 12 · HP 16 · 30**

1. **Thugs 4–6 stay on the vampires, no rolls, unless a PC reaches them.** Thugs 1–3: **a PC on Ostrander?** Gets between them. Otherwise moves to the nearest PC.
2. Crowbar: **+4 to hit, 8 bludgeoning**.

Doesn't swing at a PC who's down.

DROPS Dead. A hard hat rolls across the floor.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐

ALSO

**Angelique** · Each round, after everyone: takes a hard hat's face and taps the thug on the most-hurt PC on the shoulder. He loses his next attack.

## The booth

**MATCHUPS** Lil Stinky holds the decks; Poe Boy stays behind them, on the mic. Orlok goes for Stinky, Dracula shadows whoever holds the USB, Edward hangs back to pull PCs clear, Angelique stays by the USB holder. The party's job: get the USB to the decks and get Stinky off them.

> R1 · The USB is on the move. Poe Boy Commands its holder: “Drop.”
> R2 · The party reaches the decks. Stinky swings at the holder and smokes a vampire (Russ's heal).
> R3 · Stinky gets moved or drops. Someone plugs in.
> R4 · The recording plays. Stinky turns on Poe Boy. The room turns.
> R5 on · Stinky and Angelique on Poe Boy. The party takes him down.

**ALLIES** One vampire a round, in turn, after everyone: Orlok grips Stinky, Dracula carries the USB holder toward the decks, Edward pulls a PC clear. Narrate it, no rolls.

**WIN** A PC at the decks plugs the USB in (their action). Then narrate the recording.

**LOSING?** It can't be lost. If it drags past round 4, Dracula snatches the drive and lands it in a PC's hand at the decks.

**DJ Poe Boy** — **AC 15 · HP 120 · 30**

1. Command, one word, **DC 15 Wis save**. The PC holding the USB: “Drop.” (it lands at their feet). Nobody holding it: the PC nearest the decks, “Flee.” (they spend their next move running from him).
2. Mic stand at anyone next to him: **+4 to hit, 4 bludgeoning**. Pathetic on purpose.

**Can't drop below 1 HP until the recording plays**: at 1 he's on his knees behind the decks, still on the mic. +3 on his saves while Stinky is within 10 ft, until Stinky turns.

DROPS When the recording plays the floor ends, his Command stops landing, the room boos and Dracula takes the mic. Two rounds on, the next PC hit puts him at 0: knocked out, not killed. The fight runs into the early morning; cut to the driveway at sunrise.

HP ☐

**Lil Stinky** — **AC 18 · HP 60 · 30**

1. Back to the decks, next to Poe Boy.
2. Longsword twice: **+5 to hit, 8 radiant** each. The PC holding the USB if he can reach them, otherwise the nearest vampire.

**Nobody can plug in while he's standing at the decks.** Shove him, grapple him, move him with a spell or a vampire, or drop him, then plug in. A vampire he hits smokes and staggers: that's Russ's heal for badge req 3, if it hasn't landed.

DROPS At 0 HP he's on one knee, sword down: out of the fight, awake, and still hears the recording. When it plays, his oath breaks, no save, and he gets up on the party's side: see Allies.

HP ☐

ALSO

**Angelique** · Every round until the recording: wears Poe Boy's face beside the USB holder (nobody holding it: the PC nearest the decks). That PC has advantage on the save against his Command.

**Angelique, after the recording** · Every round: her own face, her own knife. 8 piercing on Poe Boy.

**Lil Stinky, after the recording** · Every round: one swing at Poe Boy, 8 slashing, no roll. Poe Boy can't get past him off the decks. No HP from here: at 0 he gets up anyway.

They don't drop and have no HP to track. Their hits stop Poe Boy at 1 HP: a PC lands the last one.